

Introduction

The word “culture” is a broad idea, and includes the values, beliefs, and behavior of a society, or group of people. Culture includes many things, including customs, language, religion, music, art, food, and clothing. Some points of culture are traditional, having survived virtually unchanged for centuries. Others are short-lived, such as fashion styles and trends in pop music.

Modern culture

Today's culture is fast-moving and ever-changing, thanks in part to the instant communication offered by the Internet. But long before the Internet, the migration of people around the world began introducing people to cultures different from their own. Global broadcasting then accelerated this effect in the 20th century. The cultural contact often creates a fusion (uniting) of different cultural styles, especially in the fields of music, fashion, and cooking.

Live performances

Huge crowds watch singers, such as Beyoncé (right), perform live, just as they have always done. But today the “live” audience can number many millions, with most following remotely via Internet-based platforms like YouTube or Spotify.



Stadium spectators

For many sports fans, being part of a passionate, noisy, banner-waving stadium crowd makes them feel an important part of the event.

Headdress, called a *kiritam*, varies in size and design, according to the character being portrayed.

Hand gestures (known as *mudra*) are the dancer's main way of telling the story.

Noble-hearted characters always have green faces; dark red signifies a treacherous nature.

Kathakali dancer
Indian kathakali dancers enact stories from two epic poems, the *Ramayana* and the *Mahabharata*. Dealing with the constant struggle between good and evil, dances end with the destruction of a demon.

Heroes
always wear red jackets

Dancer's skirt
is made up of many layers of white cotton.

